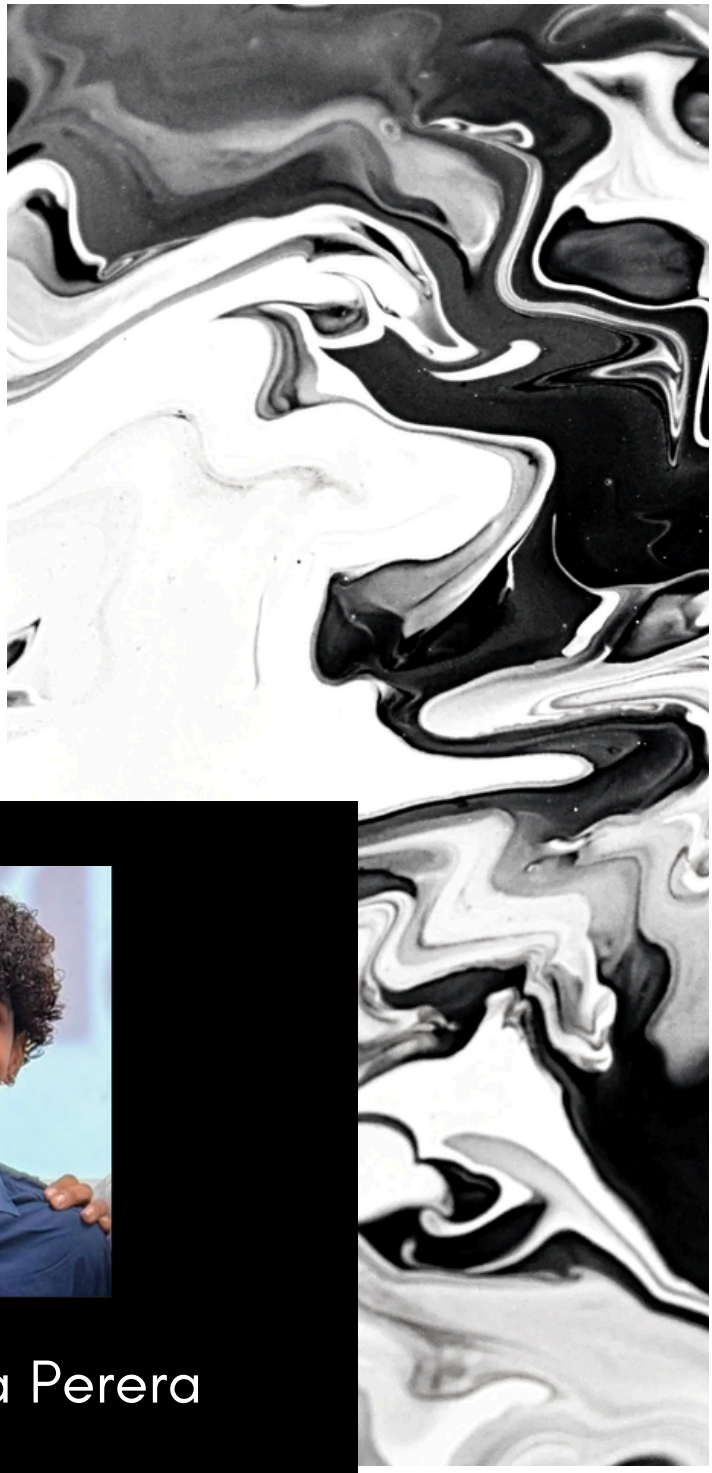
PROFESSIONAL SKILLS PORTFOLIO





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Year 2 Semester 2

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT



I WOULD LIKE TO THANK MS. ISHARA RAVIHAREE WEERASINGHE, OUR LECTURER IN CHARGE, FOR THE AMAZING SESSIONS, PRACTICAL ACTIVITIES, AND CONTINUOUS SUPPORT THROUGHOUT THIS SEMESTER. YOUR EFFORTS HAVE MADE A BIG DIFFERENCE IN OUR EDUCATION, PROFESSIONAL CONFIDENCE, AND EVERYDAY LIFE.

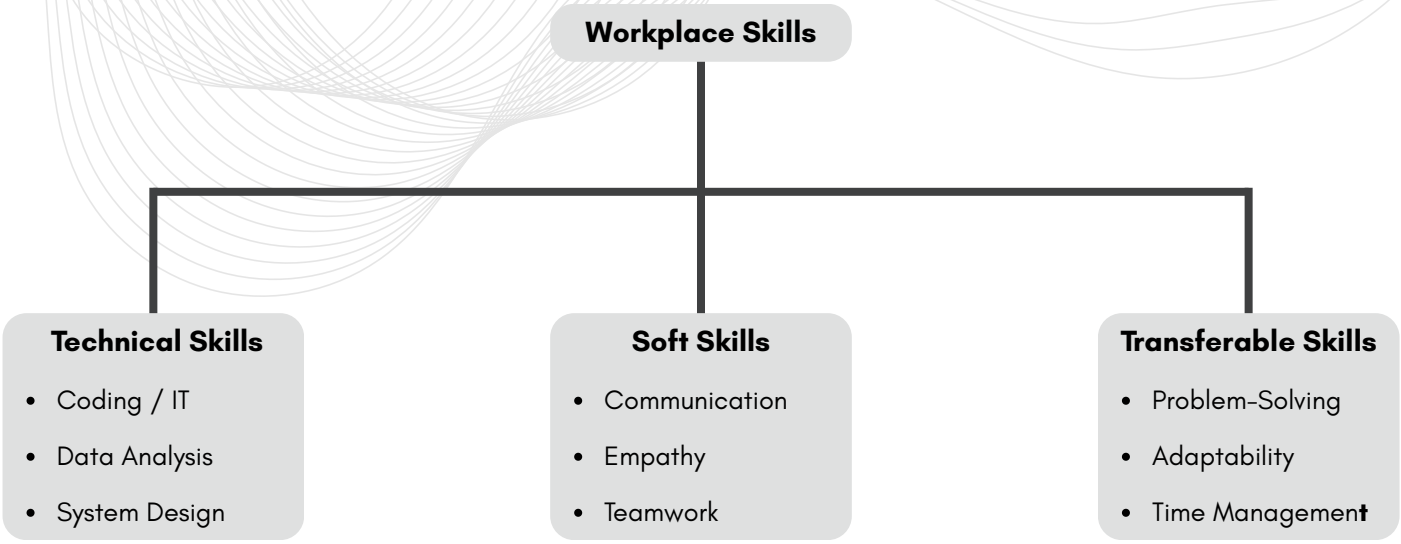
I ALSO WANT TO THANK ALL THE ACADEMIC STAFF AND MY FELLOW GROUP MEMBERS, AND PEER-EVALUATION EXERCISES. THANK YOU FOR MAKING THIS LEARNING EXPERIENCE SO MEANINGFUL AND ENJOYABLE.

01. INTRODUCTION TO PROFESSIONAL SKILLS



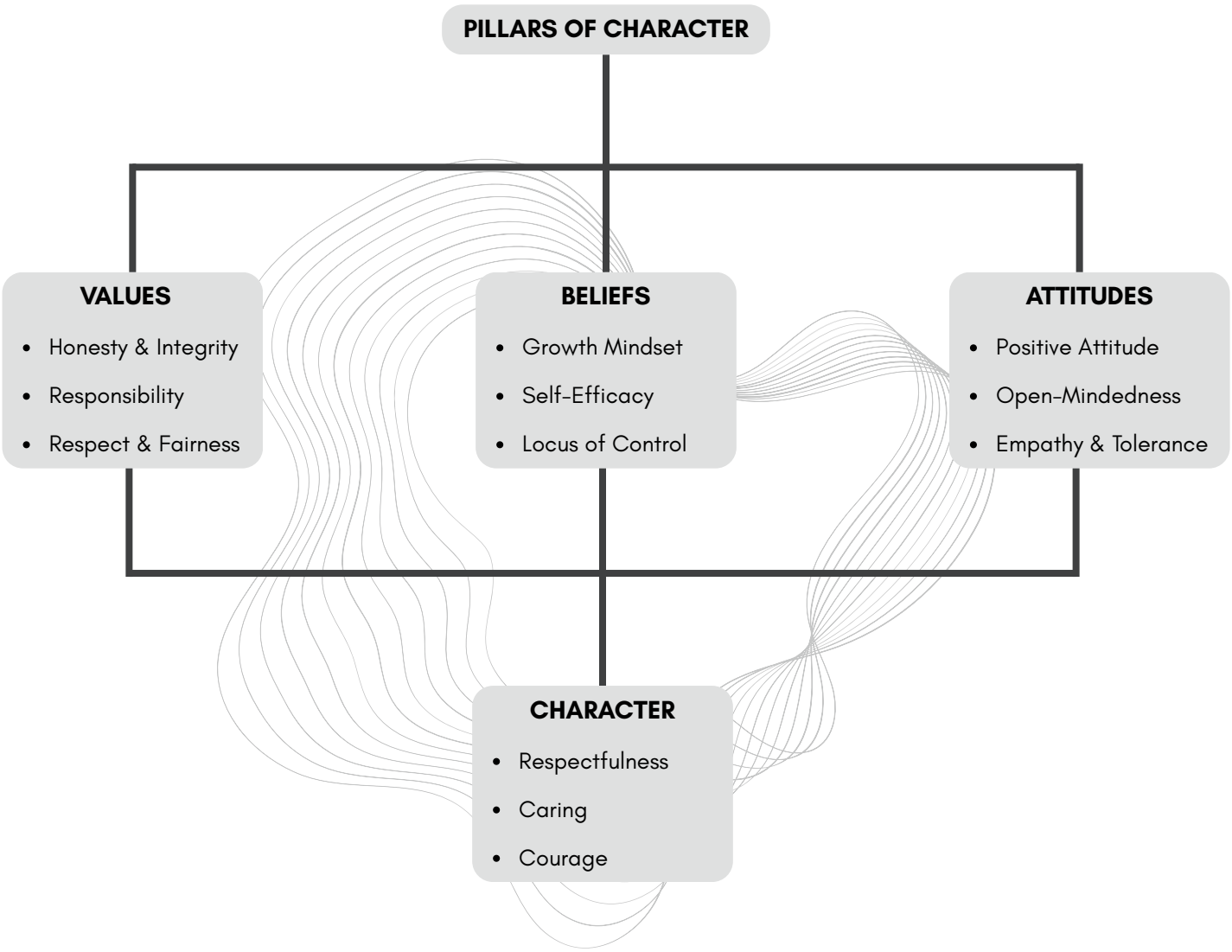
MRS. ISHARA RAVIHAREE WEERASINGHE (SENIOR LECTURER IN ENGLISH | MODULE IN CHARGE)

THE FIRST SESSION INTRODUCED THE STRUCTURE OF THE MODULE AND THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN TECHNICAL SKILLS (JOB-SPECIFIC HARD KNOWLEDGE), SOFT SKILLS (INTERPERSONAL AND COMMUNICATION SKILLS), AND TRANSFERABLE SKILLS (VERSATILE SKILLS LIKE PROBLEM-SOLVING AND ADAPTABILITY THAT APPLY ACROSS INDUSTRIES).



The Pillars of Character (Mind Map)

WE LEARNED HOW OUR INTERNAL COMPASS SHAPES OUR OUTWARD WORKPLACE REPUTATION THROUGH FOUR CONNECTED ELEMENTS:



The Johari Window Worksheet

DEVELOPED BY JOSEPH LUFT AND HARRINGTON INGHAM (1955), THE JOHARI WINDOW HELPS US BUILD SELF-AWARENESS BY COMPARING WHAT WE KNOW ABOUT OURSELVES WITH WHAT OUR TEAM MEMBERS OBSERVE IN US. USING THE MYGROW PERSONAL STRENGTHS LIST, I PLOTTED MY STRENGTHS ACROSS THE FOUR QUADRANTS:

OPEN AREA (Arena) **(Known to Self & Known to Others)** • Logical & Analytical • Team Player • Dedicated & Responsible • Motivated	**BLIND AREA (Blind Spot)** **(Known to Others, Not Known to Self)** • Peacekeeper (staying calm during group disagreements) • Perspective (helping the group see the bigger picture)
HIDDEN AREA (Façade) **(Known to Self, Not Known to Others)** • Fear of negative feedback / making mistakes • Overthinking before starting a new task	**UNKNOWN AREA** **(Unknown to Self & Unknown to Others)** • Untapped leadership in large corporate crises • Hidden negotiation talents yet to be tested in industry

Key Takeaways

- TECHNICAL SKILLS GET YOU THE INTERVIEW, BUT SOFT AND TRANSFERABLE SKILLS HELP YOU KEEP THE JOB AND GET PROMOTED.
- EXPANDING THE **OPEN AREA** REQUIRES ASKING FOR FEEDBACK (TO SHRINK THE BLIND SPOT) AND SHARING OPENLY WITH TEAMMATES (TO SHRINK THE HIDDEN AREA).
- A GROWTH MINDSET (BELIEVING ABILITIES CAN BE DEVELOPED) AND AN INTERNAL **LOCUS OF CONTROL** ARE ESSENTIAL TO OVERCOME WORKPLACE CHALLENGES.
- ALIGNING OUR VALUES, BELIEFS, AND ATTITUDES BUILDS A STRONG PROFESSIONAL **CHARACTER**.

Further Information Gathered / Readings

HTTPS://DPSHOWRAH.DSPACES.ORG/BITSTREAM/123456789/109/1/01-11-2020-205951MINDSET%20BY%20CAROL%20S.%20DWECK.PDF

MINDSET: CHANGING THE WAY YOU THINK TO FULFIL YOUR POTENTIAL BY DR. CAROL S. DWECK. (EXPLAINS HOW SHIFTING FROM A FIXED MINDSET TO A GROWTH MINDSET ALLOWS US TO TREAT FAILURES AS LEARNING OPPORTUNITIES).



2.PORTFOLIO MANAGEMENT & ENGINEERING

YOUR DIGITAL BLUEPRINT

WHILE A TRADITIONAL CV IS A STATIC 1-2 PAGE SNAPSHOT ANCHORED IN THE PAST, A **DIGITAL PORTFOLIO** IS A CONTINUOUSLY UPDATED, LIVING EVIDENCE ENGINE WITH UNLIMITED MULTIMEDIA DEPTH.

Portfolio Type	Primary Goal	Target Audience	Core Contents
1. Personal Portfolio	Express unique creative style talents	Creative fields, clients, fans	UI/UX designs, photography, writing, multimedia projects
2. Career / Dossier Portfolio	Present professional credentials for jobs/promotions	Hiring managers & Admissions panels	Cover page, TOC, Cover Letter, Resume, Recommendations, Work samples
3. Employment Portfolio	Demonstrate value as a current employee	Current managers & HR	Performance evaluations, training certificates, workplace contributions
4. Assessment Portfolio	Showcase academic learning progress, reflection & growth over time	Educators, Viva examiners & Learners	Compiled weekly reflections, worksheets, self-assessments, & evidence

The 4 Phases of Curation

- PHASE 1 - STRATEGY: DEFINE PURPOSE, IDENTIFY AUDIENCE, CHOOSE FORMAT (PHYSICAL BINDER VS. DIGITAL PDF/WEBSITE).
- PHASE 2 - ASSEMBLY: COLLECT MATERIALS, ORGANIZE LOGICALLY, AND PROVIDE CONTEXT (NEVER ASSUME AN ARTIFACT SPEAKS FOR ITSELF—EXPLAIN WHAT YOU LEARNED!).
- PHASE 3 - POLISH: SHOWCASE QUANTIFIABLE ACHIEVEMENTS, MAINTAIN CONSISTENT VISUAL FORMATTING, AND INCLUDE HONEST SELF-ASSESSMENT.
- PHASE 4 - ACTIVATION: LEVERAGE TECH, SEEK PEER/MENTOR FEEDBACK, PROTECT PRIVACY, BACK UP COPIES, AND CONTINUOUSLY UPDATE.

The Iceberg of Digital Footprint

ABOVE THE WATERLINE SITS YOUR CURATED IDENTITY (LINKEDIN, GITHUB, PERSONAL WEBSITE); BELOW THE WATERLINE LURKS YOUR PASSIVE FOOTPRINT (UNMANAGED PRIVACY SETTINGS, OLD POSTS, UNPROFESSIONAL EMAILS)

Ethical AI Mandate

USE AI TOOLS (CANVA, GITHUB COPILOT, GRAMMARLY, NOTION AI) AS CO-PILOTS TO REFINE AND STRUCTURE, NEVER AS A REPLACEMENT FOR AUTHENTIC, ORIGINAL WORK.



Key Takeaways

- **CONTEXT IS KING**: ALWAYS PAIR EVERY PROJECT OR CERTIFICATE WITH A REFLECTION EXPLAINING WHY IT MATTERS AND WHAT SKILLS IT PROVES.
- PREPARE THOROUGHLY FOR THE **PORTFOLIO VIVA** (4 RANDOM QUESTIONS FROM THE QUESTION BOX, STRICTLY FORMAL ATTIRE, ARRIVING 15 MINUTES EARLY WITH YOUR FINALIZED PORTFOLIO).

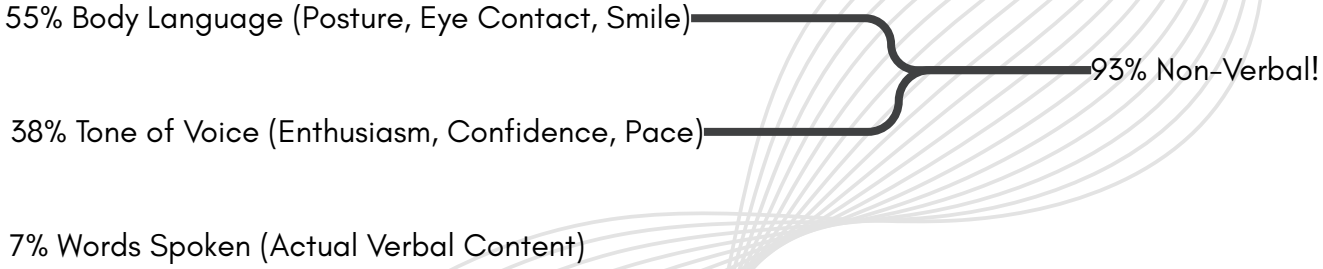
3. JOB INTERVIEWS & MOCK INTERVIEW SKILLS

A JOB INTERVIEW IS A TWO-WAY EVIDENCE-GATHERING CONVERSATION. TO PREPARE STRATEGICALLY, EVERY CANDIDATE MUST ANSWER THREE QUESTIONS BEFOREHAND

(1) WHAT DO I **WANT** THE INTERVIEWER TO KNOW ABOUT ME?
(2) WHAT WEAKNESSES DO I **WANT** TO MINIMIZE?
(3) WHAT DO I **NEED** TO KNOW ABOUT THIS JOB/ORGANIZATION?

The Role of Non-Verbal Communication (Albert Mehrabian's 7–38–55% Rule)

[FACE-TO-FACE INTERVIEW COMMUNICATION]



Successful vs. Unsuccessful Candidates & The 6 C's of Communication

Successful Candidates	Unsuccessful Candidates	The 6 C's (+ Confident)
• Researched the company & used the company name often • Maintained comfortable eye contact & SMILE • Used industry terms & technical jargon naturally • Supported claims with specific examples (STAR) • Spoke more than the interviewer & asked smart questions	• Had vague ideas & didn't know about the company • Made little eye contact & spoke in a flat, neutral tone • Resisted topic shifts & didn't use industry terms • Gave overly short answers & asked few/no questions	1. Clear: Present ideas clearly. 2. Concise: Don't be long-winded. 3. Correct: Be truthful and accurate. 4. Complete: Give full context. 5. Concrete: Give real stories/examples. 6. Courteous: Always sound polite. 7. Confident: Show a "can-do" attitude.

Structuring Answers with the STAR Method

S - SITUATION: GIVE BRIEF CONTEXT ("DURING MY YEAR 2 SEM 2 UNIVERSITY BUSINESS PROJECT...").

T - TARGET: STATE WHAT NEEDED TO BE ACHIEVED ("...OUR 4-MEMBER GROUP HAD TO REVIEW THREE DISTINCT RESEARCH PAPERS AND INTEGRATE THEM INTO A UNIFIED PRESENTATION UNDER A TIGHT DEADLINE.").

A - ACTIONS: EXPLAIN WHAT YOU DID ("I COORDINATED A CLEAR DIVISION OF TOPICS, SET INTERNAL REVIEW CHECKPOINTS, AND HELPED FORMAT OUR VISUAL SLIDES FOR CONSISTENCY.").

R - RESULT: SHARE THE OUTCOME ("AS A RESULT, WE DELIVERED A COHESIVE PRESENTATION ON TIME AND SCORED HIGH MARKS FOR TEAMWORK AND CLARITY.").

Key Takeaways

- **93% OF COMMUNICATION IS NON-VERBAL** (55% BODY LANGUAGE + 38% TONE OF VOICE).
- USE **PRESENT TENSE** FOR STRENGTHS ("I AM SKILLED AT WORKING UNDER PRESSURE"), **PAST SIMPLE / PRESENT PERFECT** FOR EXPERIENCE, AND THE **STAR FRAMEWORK** FOR BEHAVIOURAL QUESTIONS.
- ALWAYS PREPARE 2-3 THOUGHTFUL QUESTIONS TO ASK THE INTERVIEWER AT THE END.

4. CV WRITING

A **CURRICULUM VITAE (CV)** IS A FORMAL 1-TO-2-PAGE DOCUMENT PROVIDING A CONCISE SYNOPSIS OF YOUR EDUCATION, QUALIFICATIONS, WORK EXPERIENCE, AND ACHIEVEMENTS. BECAUSE RECRUITERS SPEND LESS THAN 60 SECONDS SCANNING A CV AND USE **AUTOMATED APPLICANT TRACKING SYSTEMS (ATS)**, TAILORING YOUR CV WITH KEYWORDS FROM THE JOB DESCRIPTION IS ESSENTIAL.

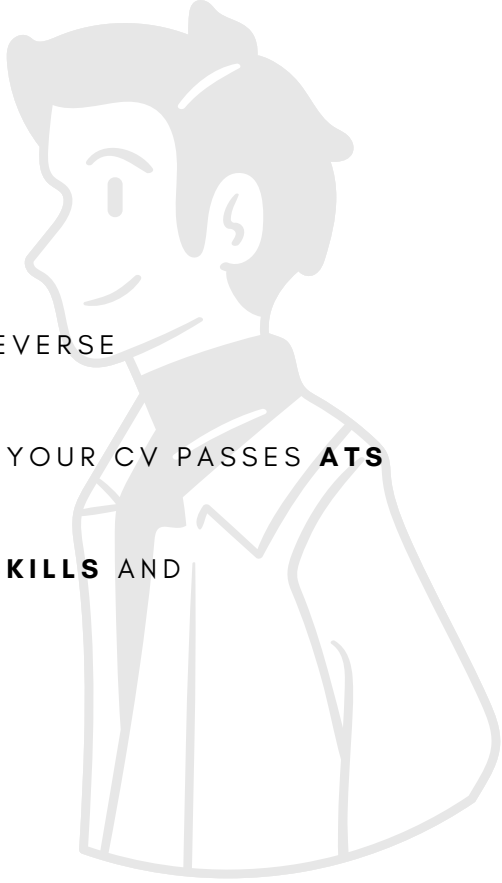
The 6 Essential Components of a Winning CV (Mind Map)

ESSENTIAL CV ARCHITECTURE

- a. Personal Information (Full Name, Phone, Professional Email, Location, LinkedIn/GitHub)
- b. Professional Summary (Tailored 3-line pitch of career goals & core value)
- c. Work Experience (Reverse chronological order + Action Verbs + Quantifiable results)
- d. Education (Reverse chronological order: Degree, Institution, Graduation Year)
- e. Categorized Skills (Hard/Technical Skills + Soft/Transferable Skills)
- f. Achievements, Projects & Awards (Certifications, Hackathons, University Projects)

Avoiding Common CV & Cover Letter Pitfalls

- **STRICT ORIGINALITY RULE**: NEVER SUBMIT GENERIC, UNEDITED AI-GENERATED CVS OR COVER LETTERS (MARKS ARE 0 FOR AI-GENERATED CVS/COVER LETTERS IN THE MOCK INTERVIEW—MUST BE AUTHENTIC AND TAILORED TO A PRINTED JOB AD!).
- **ZERO TYPOS & CONSISTENT FORMATTING**: USE CLEAN HEADINGS, BULLET POINTS, WHITE SPACE, AND A CONSISTENT FONT SIZE.
- **QUANTIFY IMPACT**: INSTEAD OF WRITING "WORKED ON A GROUP PROJECT", WRITE "COLLABORATED IN A 4-MEMBER AGILE UNIVERSITY TEAM TO DESIGN AND DEPLOY A WEB-BASED BUSINESS SOLUTION AHEAD OF SCHEDULE."



Key Takeaways

- ALWAYS LIST **WORK EXPERIENCE** AND **EDUCATION** IN REVERSE CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER (MOST RECENT FIRST).
- MIRROR KEYWORDS FROM THE JOB ADVERTISEMENT SO YOUR CV PASSES **ATS SCREENING**.
- CATEGORIZE YOUR SKILLS CLEARLY INTO **TECHNICAL SKILLS** AND **SOFT/LEADERSHIP SKILLS**.

5. SPEAKING SKILLS

MEETINGS COME IN MANY FORMS—FROM AN INFORMAL **CHAT** AT THE COFFEE MACHINE OR A **BRAINSTORMING** SESSION, TO A **PROJECT/TEAM MEETING, DEPARTMENTAL MEETING, SUPPLIER/CUSTOMER NEGOTIATION, BOARD MEETING, AGM (ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING)**, OR **EGM (EXTRAORDINARY GENERAL MEETING) FOR MAJOR** ISSUES LIKE A MERGER.

Essential Meeting Collocations & Terminology

- **ARRANGE / SET UP / FIX** A MEETING = ORGANIZE A MEETING.
- **BRING FORWARD** A MEETING = MAKE A MEETING EARLIER THAN ORIGINALLY DECIDED.
- **PUT BACK / POSTPONE** A MEETING = MAKE A MEETING LATER THAN PLANNED.
- **RUN / CHAIR** A MEETING = BE IN CHARGE OF A MEETING.
- **KEY TASKS OF THE CHAIR**:

(1) **CIRCULATE** THE AGENDA WELL IN ADVANCE
(2) **APPOINT** A MINUTE-TAKER TO TAKE THE MINUTES
(3) **ALLOCATE** TIME FOR EACH POINT
(4) **AVOID** DIGRESSIONS (RAMBLING/WANDERING OFF THE POINT)
(5) **MOVE ON** TO THE NEXT POINT
(6) **FINISH** ON TIME.

The 6 Essential Components of a Winning CV (Mind Map)

EFFECTIVE MEETINGS

10-Point Planning Checklist

- Purpose & Desired Outcome (Objectives)
- Participants & Formal/Informal style
- Date, Timing & Location
- Separate people from problems
- Papers (Invitation, Agenda, Minutes)
- Potential Problems

Contributing Effectively

- Obey ground rules & be positive
- Separate people from problems
- Keep to the topic & use simple language
- Listen actively & ask for clarification

Key Takeaways

- A GOOD CHAIRPERSON ACTS LIKE A **REFEREE** DRAWING OUT QUIET TEAMMATES AND DIPLOMATICALLY CURBING RAMBLERS.
- ALWAYS CIRCULATE THE **AGENDA WELL IN ADVANCE** AND KEEP THE MEETING ROOM **COOL RATHER THAN WARM** SO PARTICIPANTS STAY ALERT.
- **SEPARATE PEOPLE FROM PROBLEMS**: NEVER MAKE PERSONAL CRITICISMS DURING A DEBATE.

6. PROFESSIONAL EMAIL & ONLINE ETIQUETTE

EMAIL IS THE PRIMARY OFFICIAL COMMUNICATION CHANNEL IN UNIVERSITIES AND WORKPLACES. AN UNPROFESSIONAL EMAIL ADDRESS (LIKE 1MANWOLFPACK@GMAIL.COM) OR A SLOPPY MESSAGE IMMEDIATELY SIGNALS A LACK OF WORKPLACE READINESS.

Anatomy of a Formal Email

To: normanbooth@travelwellhotel.org (Check Reply vs. Reply All!)
From: kaushadha.perera@gmail.com (Professional English name account)
Subject: Software Engineering Intern Candidate – Kaushadha Perera

1. SALUTATION: Dear Mr. Perera, / Dear Professor Jayawardane, / Dear Ms. Maneesha,
2. OPENING: State the purpose clearly in the first sentence.
3. BODY: Concise paragraphs separated by white space. Full words (no contractions like "I'm" or slang like "gonna" / "LOL").
4. CLOSING STATEMENT: "I look forward to hearing from you. Thank you."
5. SIGN-OFF & SIGNATURE:
Yours sincerely, / Kind regards, / Best,
Kaushadha Perera
BSc Undergraduate | SCU | Mobile: +94 XX XXX XXXX

The 7 Golden Rules of Online & Email Etiquette

1. **ALWAYS INCLUDE A CLEAR SUBJECT LINE & PROPER TITLE/NAME**: NEVER PUT "HELLO" IN THE SUBJECT LINE OR WRITE A FULL SENTENCE. USE DEAR DR. / PROFESSOR / MR. / MS. + LAST NAME.
2. **NEVER WRITE IN ALL CAPITALS**: TYPING IN ALL CAPS (FINISHED!) CONVEYS SHOUTING AND TRIGGERS NEGATIVE REACTIONS.
3. **NEVER SEND CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION**: DO NOT EMAIL BANK/CREDIT CARD NUMBERS, PASSWORDS, OR MEDICAL RECORDS.
4. **AVOID ABBREVIATIONS, EMOTICONS & EXCLAMATION MARKS**: SAVE LOL, IDK, <3, AND !!! FOR TEXT MESSAGES WITH FRIENDS.
5. **THINK BEFORE YOU SEND (THE 24-HOUR RULE)**: NEVER USE EMAIL FOR CONFRONTATION OR WHEN ANGRY, SLEEP ON IT FOR 24 HOURS.
6. **USE POLITE MODALS INSTEAD OF DEMANDS**: PROFESSORS AND MANAGERS ARE BUSY; REQUEST RATHER THAN DEMAND.
7. **DO NOT FORWARD JUNK / CHAIN EMAILS**: NEVER FORWARD CHAIN MAIL OR UNVERIFIED MESSAGES WITHOUT A PERSONAL NOTE OF VALUE.

Tone Makeover Table: Demanding vs. Polite Professional Tone

Inappropriate / Demanding Tone	Polite / Professional Option (Using Modals)
"I want to make an appointment with you tomorrow at 12:00 so you can explain it more to me."	"I am still a bit confused by aspects of yesterday's lecture. Would it be possible to schedule an appointment this week? I am free Tuesday or Thursday afternoon."
"I'd like you to look at my project and get it back to me by next Tuesday."	"My project is due next Tuesday. If you have time, would you mind taking a look at it and giving me some feedback?"
"Please help me. I have some problems here."	*"I am having some difficulty with X. Would you mind helping me with this?"*



Key Takeaways

- **EMAILS ARE NOT TEXT MESSAGES**: ALWAYS USE FULL WORDS, PROPER GRAMMAR, PARAGRAPH SPACING, AND A FORMAL SIGNATURE BLOCK.
- KNOW KEY WORKPLACE ABBREVIATIONS: **ASAP** (AS SOON AS POSSIBLE), **FYI** (FOR YOUR INFORMATION—NO REPLY NEEDED), **COB** (CLOSE OF BUSINESS, 5:00 PM), **RSVP** (RÉPONDEZ S'IL VOUS PLAÎT PLEASE REPLY).
- WHEN EXPLAINING AN ABSENCE, INFORM **POLITELY WITHOUT GRAPHIC MEDICAL DETAILS**, AND OFFER **AT LEAST TWO TIME SLOTS** WHEN REQUESTING A MEETING.

7. TELEPHONE ETIQUETTE & CUSTOMER SERVICE

BECAUSE **55% OF FACE-TO-FACE COMMUNICATION IS BODY LANGUAGE**, SPEAKING ON THE TELEPHONE REQUIRES EXTRA VOCAL CLARITY, ACTIVE LISTENING, AND WARMTH TO COMPENSATE FOR THE LACK OF VISUAL CUES. EVERY TIME WE ANSWER A WORK PHONE, WE REPRESENT THE ENTIRE ORGANIZATION.

STEPS TO TELEPHONE EXCELLENCE

- Step 1: Answer Promptly (Within 3 rings) & Smile!
- Step 2: Begin with an Introduction (Dept + Name + "How may I help?")
- Step 3: Give Full Attention (No multitasking or side chats)
- Step 4: Take Good Notes & Repeat (Recap facts, spell names numbers)
- Step 5: Avoid Annoying Habits (No gum chewing/eating - Misophonia!)
- Step 6: Resolve Issues Immediately (Use a Desk Cheat Sheet; <30-45s hold)
- Step 7: End on a Positive Note (Action plan + "Thank you" + "Good-bye")

Tone Makeover Table: Demanding vs. Polite Professional Tone

KEEPING A SMALL MIRROR AT YOUR DESK WITH A NOTE THAT SAYS **"SMILE!"** IS NOT JUST **PSYCHOLOGICAL**. IT IS PHYSIOLOGICAL. WHEN YOU SMILE, **THE SOFT PALATE AT THE BACK OF YOUR MOUTH RAISES**, MAKING SOUND WAVES MORE FLUID AND GIVING YOUR VOICE A WARM, FRIENDLY, AND RECEPTIVE TONE.

The 5 Rules of Putting a Caller on Hold & Handling Angry Callers

5 Rules for Putting a Caller on Hold	Dealing with Angry / Upset Callers
1. **Ask permission** before putting them on hold ("May I put you on hold?"). 2. **Wait for their response** before pressing hold (never just set the handset down!). 3. **Explain why** they are being placed on hold. 4. **Give a time frame** (keep holds under **30–45 seconds**; if longer, offer to call back). 5. **Thank them for holding** as soon as you return.	• Remember they are mad at the issue, **not at you personally**. • Show sincere empathy: "I'm sorry about that; tell me what happened." • Do not interrupt, challenge the complaint, or blame others. • Take careful notes, repeat their name and number, and commit to a clear solution within 1 **working day**.

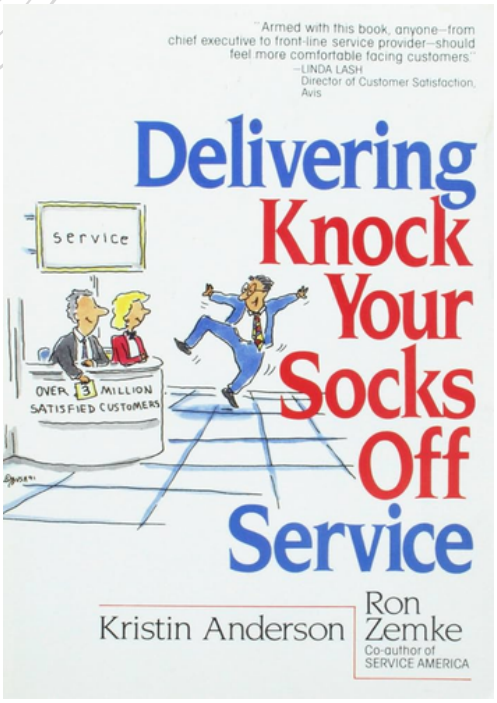
Key Takeaways

- ANSWER BEFORE THE **3RD RING**, SPEAK **1 INCH** FROM THE MOUTHPIECE, AND SMILE TO RAISE YOUR SOFT PALATE.
- **80% OF CALLERS** FIND EATING OR CHEWING GUM ON THE PHONE RUDE (TRIGGERS **MISOPHONIA** HATRED OF SOUND).
- NEVER TRANSFER A CALLER BLINDLY ("WARM TRANSFER" BY BRIEFING YOUR COLLEAGUE FIRST AND GIVING THE CALLER THE EXTENSION NUMBER IN CASE OF DISCONNECTION).
- LET THE CALLER **HANG UP** FIRST AND END WITH A PROFESSIONAL "GOOD-BYE" (NEVER "SEE YA" OR "BYE-BYE").

Further Information Gathered / Readings

HTTPS://BOOKS.GOOGLE.COM.LY/BOOKS?ID=IZMZARTBOQCC&PRINTSEC=FRONTCOVER&HL=AR&SOURCE=GBS_GE_SUMMARY_R&CAD=0#V=ONEPAGE&Q&F=FALSE

BOOK: DELIVERING KNOCK YOUR SOCKS OFF SERVICE BY KRISTIN ANDERSON & RON ZEMKE.



8. EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE & BRAIN DYNAMICS

WE STARTED THE SESSION BY BREAKING DOWN **EMOTIONS + INTELLIGENCE**. AN EMOTION IS A COMPLEX PSYCHOLOGICAL STATE WITH THREE COMPONENTS: **SUBJECTIVE EXPERIENCE (FEELING), PHYSIOLOGICAL RESPONSE**, AND **BEHAVIOURAL RESPONSE**. ACCORDING TO **CHARLES DARWIN**, FACIAL EXPRESSIONS EVOLVED TO AID HUMAN SURVIVAL (E.G., SURPRISE WIDENS THE EYES TO TAKE IN MORE INFORMATION; DISGUST WRINKLES THE NOSE AGAINST FOUL ODOURS). WE ALSO LEARNED ABOUT **MIRROR NEURONS** IN THE PREMOTOR CORTEX, WHICH FIRE WHEN WE OBSERVE OTHERS' ACTIONS AND PROVIDE THE BIOLOGICAL BASIS FOR **EMPATHY**.

The 5 Rules of Putting a Caller on Hold & Handling Angry Callers

PSYCHOLOGIST **PAUL EKMAN IDENTIFIED 6 BASIC (HARD-WIRED)** EMOTIONS THAT APPEAR IN INFANTS ACROSS ALL CULTURES, WHILE OTHER SOCIAL EMOTIONS MUST BE TAUGHT AND PRACTICED:

HUMAN EMOTIONS

6 Hard-Wired Emotions

1. Joy / Happiness
2. Anger
3. Disgust
4. Surprise
5. Sadness
6. Fear

Taught Emotions

- Humility
- Forgiveness
- Empathy
- Optimism & Patience
- Compassion & Gratitude

The 3 Brains & How "Amygdala Hijacking" Happens

OUR BRAIN IS DIVIDED INTO THREE EVOLUTIONARY LAYERS, AND OUR CONSCIOUS MIND MAKES ONLY **5% OF DECISIONS** (AT 40 BITS/SECOND), WHILE OUR **UNCONSCIOUS MIND MAKES 95%** (PROCESSING 11 MILLION BITS/SECOND):

1. NEOCORTEX (Human Brain / Prefrontal Cortex - "The CEO") Logic, abstract thought, planning, impulse inhibition
2. LIMBIC SYSTEM (Mammalian Brain - Amygdala & Hippocampus) Emotions, empathy, memory, fight-or-flight seat
3. REPTILIAN COMPLEX (Brain Stem & Cerebellum) Instinctive survival, autonomic functions

- **AMYGDALA HIJACK (LOW ROAD VS. HIGH ROAD)**: WHEN A STRESSFUL STIMULUS HITS THE **THALAMUS**, THE "LOW ROAD" SENDS A SHORTCUT SIGNAL DIRECTLY TO THE AMYGDALA BEFORE THE RATIONAL **NEOCORTEX (HIGH ROAD)** CAN PROCESS IT. THIS CAUSES US TO "SHOOT FIRST AND ASK QUESTIONS LATER".
-
- **BRAIN DEVELOPMENT & PRUNING**: THE BRAIN UNDERGOES SYNAPSE OVERPRODUCTION (AGES 0-3 AND 10-13) FOLLOWED BY **SYNAPTIC PRUNING** AND **MYELINATION** (WHICH INCREASES IMPULSE SPEED 100X AND CONTINUES UNTIL AGE **25**).

The 5 Rules of Putting a Caller on Hold & Handling Angry Callers

STUDIES BY TALENTSMART AND PSI SHOW THAT **EQ ACCOUNTS FOR 58% OF JOB PERFORMANCE, 90% OF TOP PERFORMERS HAVE HIGH EI**, AND MANAGERS TRAINED IN EI DELIVER **TWICE THE PROFIT**.

EQ (Emotional Intelligence)	**IQ (Intelligence Quotient)**
• Focuses on understanding & managing emotions • **Can be enhanced throughout life** • Builds empathy, self-control, motivation, & social skills • Gets you promoted and builds leadership	• Focuses on cognitive, academic, & logic abilities • Largely established at birth • Builds technical know-how, analysis, & design • Gets you hired at the entry level

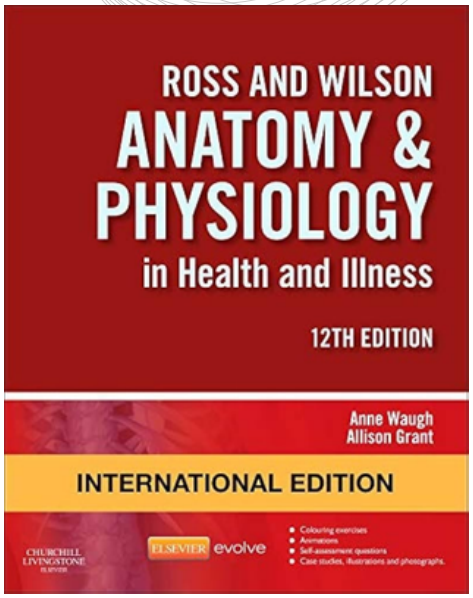
Key Takeaways

- **EQ > IQ IN THE WORKPLACE**: EMPLOYERS VALUE HIGH EI BECAUSE EMPLOYEES STAY CALM UNDER PRESSURE, RESOLVE CONFLICTS EFFECTIVELY, AND SHOW EMPATHY.
- **PAUSE TO PREVENT AMYGDALA HIJACK**: TAKING 6-10 SECONDS TO BREATHE ALLOWS THE SIGNAL TO REACH THE PREFRONTAL CORTEX ("THE CEO OF THE BRAIN") BEFORE REACTING.
- **EMOTIONAL CONTAGION**: POSITIVE EMOTIONS BOOST IMMUNITY **(S-IGA)** AND SPREAD TO TEAMMATES LIKE A MIRROR.
- **BALANCE NEUROTRANSMITTERS**: DOPAMINE (COMPLETING SMALL WINS), SEROTONIN (SUNLIGHT/MEDITATION), OXYTOCIN (SOCIAL TRUST), AND ENDORPHINS (EXERCISE) KEEP STRESS HORMONES BALANCED.

Further Information Gathered / Readings

https://napier-repository.worktribe.com/output/180811/ross-and-wilson-anatomy-and-physiology-in-health-and-illness-12th-edition

BOOK: ROSS AND WILSON ANATOMY & PHYSIOLOGY IN HEALTH AND ILLNESS (12TH EDITION) - READ ABOUT HOW NEURONS COMMUNICATE ACROSS THE SYNAPSE USING NEUROTRANSMITTERS LIKE NORADRENALINE, SEROTONIN, AND DOPAMINE.



9. DINING ETIQUETTE & TABLE MANNERS

DINING ETIQUETTE IS NOT JUST ABOUT RULES; IT IS ABOUT **BEING COMFORTABLE AND MAKING OTHERS COMFORTABLE** WHILE EXTENDING RESPECT AND COURTESY DURING BUSINESS LUNCHES AND FORMAL DINNERS.

FORMAL TABLE SETTING RULES

Outside-In Rule

Start with the outermost utensils and work your way inward with each course.

The "b" & "d" Tip

- Left hand forms "b" =Bread & Butter plate
- Right hand forms "d" = Drinks (Water, Wine)

Napkin Etiquette

- Wait for host first
- Fold into triangle/ rectangle on lap
- Excusing yourself? Place on chair!

Essential Rules of the Table

- **BREAKING BREAD**: NEVER CUT OR BITE A WHOLE ROLL; BREAK OFF AND EAT ONE SMALL PIECE AT A TIME. TAKE BUTTER FROM THE COMMUNITY DISH ONTO YOUR BREAD PLATE FIRST.
- **SALT & PEPPER ("PENGUINS")**: SALT AND PEPPER ARE LIKE PENGUINS BLACK AND WHITE AND TOGETHER FOR LIFE. ALWAYS PASS THEM **TOGETHER** TO THE RIGHT (HELD AT THE BASE), EVEN IF SOMEONE ONLY ASKS FOR ONE.
- **SOUP RULES**: "AS LONG AS SHIPS SAIL OUT TO SEA, I'LL SPOON MY SOUP AWAY FROM ME." WHEN FINISHED, PLACE THE SOUP SPOON ON THE UNDER-PLATE, NEVER INSIDE THE EMPTY BOWL.
- **U.F.O. (UNIDENTIFIED FOOD OBJECT)**: REMOVE A BONE OR GRISTLE USING THE **SAME UTENSIL** USED TO PUT IT IN YOUR MOUTH AND PLACE IT ON THE SIDE OF YOUR PLATE (NEVER IN A NAPKIN).

Silverware Styles & Resting / Finished Positions

THERE ARE TWO WAYS TO HOLD UTENSILS (**PENCIL METHOD VS. SCALPEL METHOD**) AND TWO DINING STYLES:

Feature	**Continental / European Style** ***(Recommended for slow eaters)***	**American Style (Recommended for fast eaters)**
Cutting & Eating	Cut food and **do not switch hands**; eat with fork in left hand, tines facing **DOWN**.	Cut food, place knife on plate edge, **switch fork to right hand**, eat with tines facing **UP**.
Resting Position (Not Finished)	Utensils crossed in an inverted "V" in the center of the plate, **fork tines DOWN**, knife blade facing you.	Knife on top right rim (blade facing in); fork near bottom right with **tines UP**.
Finished Position (Both Styles)	Place knife and fork parallel at the 4:25 clock position, fork tines **UPWARD** and knife blade facing **inward** toward you.	Same **4:25 clock position** (helps the server secure utensils with their thumb when clearing).

Key Takeaways

- ALWAYS FOLLOW THE **"OUTSIDE-IN"** RULE FOR SILVERWARE AND THE **"B AND D"** FINGER TRICK FOR BREAD (LEFT) AND DRINKS (RIGHT).
- NEVER PICK UP A DROPPED UTENSIL, USE A TOOTHPICK AT THE TABLE, OR REARRANGE PLACE CARDS.
- SIGNAL YOU ARE FINISHED BY PLACING YOUR FORK AND KNIFE PARALLEL AT **4:25.**
- SEND A **HANDWRITTEN THANK YOU NOTE** WHENEVER SOMEONE SPENDS MORE THAN 15-20 MINUTES HOSTING OR ASSISTING YOU.

Further Information Gathered / Readings

https://www.perlego.com/ereader/2428432

- **BOOK: THE RITUALS OF DINNER (1991)** BY MARGARET VISSER - EXPLAINS HOW THE SYSTEMATIC SHARING OF FOOD AND TABLE MANNERS LIE AT THE ROOT OF HUMAN CIVILIZATION

